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“Branding is what people say about you when you are not in the room.”



-Jeff Bezos





Malini's passion for racquet sports, featuring participation in annual internal badminton tournament

Building at Renesas: Beyond roles

The self-awareness Malini developed over the years shaped the kind of organisation she wanted to build. Today, as President of Renesas India, she leads at a time when the country's semiconductor ecosystem is expanding rapidly. Her vision is to build electronics for India, but products, she says, begin with people. Throughout her career so far, she often felt constrained by invisible boundaries and defined roles. She wanted to create something different: a blank canvas where people could move beyond job descriptions, explore new ideas, discover strengths they did not know they possessed, and contribute in ways they never imagined. Because, as her own journey has shown, potential is often discovered not within the boundaries of a role, but beyond them.

A different definition of success

When asked what she hopes young professionals take away from her journey, Malini says, “Life is a balance of many things: career, kids, health, and family. If it becomes lopsided, life cannot be peaceful. There is no time for politics or pettiness. Motherhood deepened that perspective for me.”

Even amidst the demands of leadership, family, and travel, one habit has remained remarkably constant throughout her life: exercise. It is her daily commitment to health and mental well-being. Looking back, it mirrors the way she has approached most things in life: progress comes from consistency and resilience.

From then to now

The story began with a young girl standing nervously on a stage, trying to sing through a moment of embarrassment while the audience laughed around her. Today, she is a female leader helping shape one of India's most important semiconductor organisations. What makes Malini's journey so far remarkable is how she travelled it. Not through certainty, but through curiosity. Not through perfection, but through persistence. Always willing to grow and learn. Taking the best from every relationship.

Looking back, it becomes clear that her story was never only about becoming a leader. Perhaps that is the lesson that lingers long after the story ends: leadership is not a destination reserved for a gifted few. It is a lifelong practice of awareness, learning, listening, adapting, and showing up again, much like a young girl who once walked back onto a stage after failing, determined to try one more time. EFY